

Team 14 Project Charter

Team Members:

Kathleen Lowe, Ben Herrington, Sofia Hughes, Brayden Reimann, Vidya Madana

Problem Statement:

While there are sites online for users to discuss their favorite pieces of literary media, few replicate the experience of going to a book club in person. In a book club, people can discuss novels as they go along; no spoilers are being discussed because the understanding is that everyone has read up to a certain point. Sites like GoodReads only provide spaces to review books completely with or without spoilers; we intend to create a forum-like site for users to discuss books chapter-by-chapter as they go. Here, users can connect with a reading community at their own pace. Additionally, by bringing in these social features, we distinguish our site from StoryGraph's "buddy read" feature by broadening the audience that users interact with. Our app serves as a platform for passionate readers to connect with others who are reading the same books as them, interested in similar genres, and have their own recommendations to share. Along with a chapter-by-chapter reading forum, our app will also have a dedicated social network for users to share updates about what they're reading, share book recommendations, and more. Through our app, readers around the world can connect with one another and discuss their current reads.

Project Objectives:

This project will do all of the following:

1. Connecting readers to a community of others who share similar passions.
2. Encourage strong reading habits by making finishing a chapter or book engaging and exciting.
3. Enable self-reflection by allowing readers to log their thoughts chapter-by-chapter and then review them later.

Stakeholders:

Users: Readers, particularly readers who enjoy the social aspect of a book club.

Developers: Kathleen Lowe, Ben Herrington, Sofia Hughes, Brayden Reimann, Vidya Madana

Project Coordinator: Zhou Xuan

Project Owners: Kathleen Lowe, Ben Herrington, Sofia Hughes, Brayden Reimann, Vidya Madana

Deliverables:

- Front end mobile application that can be navigated to interact with all different aspects of the app, most likely using React Native for mobile development or web development,

along with UI libraries such as React Native Paper and Bare React Native. For our backend we plan to use Node.js + Express, as we have decent experience with javascript. For our book database we plan to use MySQL or GraphQL to collect data entries on a variety of books, broken down by chapters.

- **Forum functionality:** Users will be able to leave comments and respond to others after each chapter of books that are on the site.
- **User profile:** It will be customizable, with a user able to create their own profile pictures and biography, as well as spotlight their top three books.
- **Personalized tracking:** Users will be able to track where they are in any book they are currently reading. The site will compile statistics and show the user how much they have read and show their habits.
- **Privacy settings:** Users will be able to read comments without logging them. Users can keep books off of their public shelf.
- **Group reading:** Users can form groups and invite other users to the group. Group members can select or change the group's current read and see where group members are in the book.